The Fork at the Port

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 15

Two low shelves stood at the port fork. One held workshop notices. The other was marked for current borrowers. Nib could see shore on both sides, but only one shelf matched Train's slip. Lark kept the token and book together while checking the last part of the handoff.

“More shores than I expected,” Nib remarked. “One borrower on this shore,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

saw

“Or in fork and corn, and ore in shore, represent the modeled sound in these words,” Lark explained clearly. “Read each with our ordinary pronunciation. A word like shore has familiar sh at the start and its own prepared vowel spelling at the end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try fork, corn, shore. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the prepared shore label,” Lark invited gently. “Which shelf matches the actual borrower's slip rather than the workshop notice?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The fork is by the shore. The corn is on the cart.**

“Where is the corn?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about the cart?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Train reached the supported borrower shelf with its coin-shaped token. Lark entered the third loan exactly once. Sea remained at Commons and Moon at Reed Creek; nobody reclaimed those books to refill the boat. Phone was now the sole requested book still aboard. The boat turned toward Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shore beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked Farm Quay complete. Nib could enjoy the idea of the foldout train reaching its reader. At Mill Pond, a record board had small cells for receipts and a separate tray for money.